Creamy Lemon & Wild Oregano Chicken

FROM NELL'S KITCHEN

Lemon and fresh wild oregano give this creamy chicken its bright, fragrant flavour.

Serves 3–4 · Prep 25 min · Cook 30 min

INGREDIENTS

FOR THE CHICKEN AND MARINADE

- 500 g chicken breast, sliced into evenly sized cutlets
- 1 cup laban (plain yogurt)

FOR THE SAUCE

- 1 tbsp butter
- ½ cup fresh lemon juice
- 2 tbsp smoked paprika
- 1 tbsp Dijon mustard
- ½ cup fresh zouba3 leaves (wild oregano), washed and dried
- ½ tsp black pepper
- ½ tsp fleur de sel, adjusted to taste
- 2 cups crème fraîche

FOR THE POTATO CRISPS

- 600 g potatoes
- Salt, to taste
- Vegetable oil, for deep-frying

METHOD

1. Marinate the chicken. Place the chicken in a bowl with the laban and toss until thoroughly coated. Cover and refrigerate for 1–2 hours.
2. Prepare the potatoes. Using a mandolin with its hand guard, slice the potatoes into very thin rounds. Spread over a clean kitchen towel and pat completely dry.
3. Cook the chicken. Lift the chicken from the marinade, letting the excess drip off, and discard the remaining marinade. Melt the butter in a large frying pan over medium heat. Add the chicken and cook until golden on both sides, working in batches if needed. Transfer to a plate.
4. Make the sauce. Reduce the heat to low. Stir the smoked paprika into the butter briefly, then add the lemon juice and Dijon mustard, stirring to lift any browned bits from the pan.
5. Stir in the crème fraîche, wild oregano, black pepper and fleur de sel. Bring to a gentle simmer.
6. Return the chicken and its collected juices to the pan. Simmer gently until the chicken is cooked through and the sauce has come together. Taste and adjust the seasoning.
7. Fry the potatoes. Heat the frying oil in a deep, heavy saucepan, leaving plenty of space above the oil. Working in small batches, lightly salt the dried potato slices immediately before carefully lowering them into the oil. Fry until golden and crisp.
8. Lift out with a slotted spoon and drain on a wire rack or kitchen paper. Repeat with the remaining potatoes.
9. Serve the chicken with plenty of lemon and wild oregano sauce, keeping the potato crisps alongside so they retain their crunch.

Tip

Use fresh wild oregano. Zouba3 is wild oregano; this recipe calls for the fresh leaves, rather than a dried za'atar seasoning blend.